TCS CORPORATE WEBSITE

Separator — Authoring Guide

Role / audience	Authoring — Content authors, content managers, AEM authoring leads
Version	1.0
Status	Draft for review
Owner	Content Lead / AEM Authoring Lead (proposed)
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Separator — Authoring Guide

Attribute	Value
Document ID	AUT-C-separator
Audience	Content authors, content managers, AEM authoring leads
Purpose	How to add, fill in and check the Separator component
Scope	—
Prerequisites	—
Owner	Content Lead / AEM Authoring Lead (proposed)
Approver	Product Owner (to be confirmed)
Version	1.0
Status	Draft for review
Last updated	8 November 2026
Last validated	8 November 2026
Source files	blocks/separator/README.md, blocks/separator/_separator.json
Related documents	—
Related AEM paths	—

1. Where to see it

- https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/separator
- https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/separator/option-reference
- https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/separator/separator-variations
- https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/separator/theme-auto

2. For Content Authors

1. **Add the block.** In Universal Editor select a Section, a Columns Container column or a Tabs Container, choose **Add (+)** and pick **Separator**. A new separator stores Decorative, Default, Theme Auto, Line opacity 100%, Maximum width None, Alignment Center, shown on desktop / tablet / mobile, Respect content maximum width on, no animation and Show when printed.
2. **Open its properties.** Select it in the content tree; the panel shows **General**, **Style** and **Additional**.
3. **General tab.** Choose **Accessibility mode**: Semantic for a real change of topic (optionally an **Accessible label**, e.g. "End of the case study"), Decorative for a visual division. Choose a **Separator variant** and, when the background isn't a section style (e.g. an image), a **Theme**.
4. **Style tab, the look.** Leave Line style, Line thickness, Line colour and Separator width on "As the variant" to keep the variant, or override them; set **Line opacity**, **Maximum width**, **Alignment** and the **Start / Center / End decoration**.
5. **Style tab, per device.** Turn **Show on desktop / tablet / mobile** off where it isn't wanted; set **Desktop / Tablet / Mobile width, thickness and alignment** ("As Appearance" keeps the values above) and **top / bottom spacing** per device (Default 1.5rem, i.e. 24px); turn on **Use section padding** to drop the separator's own spacing.
6. **Style tab, extras. Animate on view** (Fade, Draw from start, Draw from center) with its **Reduced motion fallback**; **Print**; **Analytics** with an **Analytics label**.

7. **Additional tab.** Anchor ID, Hide block and Padding / Margin (no animation fields: the Separator has its own Animate on view).
8. **Preview and publish.** Check the separator at desktop (from 1200px), tablet (600–1199px) and mobile (under 600px) widths in Preview; publish the page.
9. **Validate the published output.** The line appears only on the intended devices with the intended spacing; a Semantic separator is in the accessibility tree as a separator.

Minimum required content: none (an empty separator is a Default, Decorative line). **Recommended:** the right Accessibility mode. **Optional:** everything else.

3. Authorable Fields

Separator (`separator`)

Model `separator`; template name "Separator" (the block class AEM renders); key-value block (one row per property).

Stored on a new component (definition template): `accessibilityMode` = `"decorative"`, `variant` = `"default"`, `theme` = `"auto"`, `lineOpacity` = `"100"`, `maxWidth` = `"none"`, `alignment` = `"center"`, `showDesktop` = `true`, `showTablet` = `true`, `showMobile` = `true`, `respectMaxWidth` = `true`, `animateOnView` = `"none"`, `printVisibility` = `"show"`.

General tab — Separator

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Component ID	`componentId`	text	No	—	regExp: ^[A-Za-z][A-Za-z0-9_-]*$; customErrorMsg: Start with a letter; use letters, digits, - and _.	Unique on the page (letters, digits, - and _). Used by CSS, analytics, tests and links to #id, so changing it changes those. Empty: generated (separator-1, separator-2, ... in page order). Kept for separators authored before; see the other settings. Shown when `componentId` is set.	separator-chapter-break
Accessibility mode	`accessibilityMode`	select	No	`decorative`	Decorative (visual only) (`decorative`), Semantic (a thematic break) (`semantic`)	Semantic: screen readers announce a separator (a change of topic). Decorative: hidden from them (visual division only).	decorative
Accessible label	`accessibleLabel`	text	No	—	—	Optional. Names the break for screen readers, e.g. "End of the case study". Most separators need none. Shown when `accessibilityMode` is `semantic`.	End of the story
Separator variant	`variant`	select	No	`default`	Default (`default`), Subtle (`subtle`), Strong (`strong`), Inset (`inset`), Full width (`full-width`), Dotted (`dotted`), Dashed (`dashed`), Gradient (`gradient`), Branded (`branded`)	A preset of line style, thickness, colour and width; the Appearance settings override it.	branded
Theme	`theme`	select	No	`auto`	Auto (as the section) (`auto`), Light background (`light`), Dark background (`dark`), Brand background (`brand`)	—	light

Style tab — Separator

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Line style	`lineStyle`	select	No	""	As the variant (""), Solid (`solid`), Dashed (`dashed`), Dotted (`dotted`), Gradient (`gradient`), None (spacing only) (`none`)	None keeps the spacing without a line. A semantic separator stays a break for screen readers but shows nothing; prefer Decorative or remove it.	none
Line thickness	`lineThickness`	select	No	""	As the variant (""), Thin (1px) (`thin`), Medium (2px) (`medium`), Thick (3px) (`thick`)	—	thick
Line colour	`lineColor`	select	No	""	As the variant (""), Default (`default`), Subtle (`subtle`), Neutral (`neutral`), Strong (`strong`), Primary (brand) (`primary`), Secondary (light brand) (`secondary`), Accent (`accent`), Inverse (on dark) (`inverse`)	—	accent
Line opacity	`lineOpacity`	select	No	`100`	25% (`25`), 50% (`50`), 75% (`75`), 100% (`100`)	—	100
Separator width	`width`	select	No	""	As the variant (""), 25% (`25-percent`), 50% (`50-percent`), 75% (`75-percent`), 100% (`100-percent`), Content width (`content-width`), Full bleed (section edge to edge) (`full-bleed`)	—	25-percent
Maximum width	`maxWidth`	select	No	`none`	None (`none`), Small (320px) (`small`), Medium (640px) (`medium`), Large (960px) (`large`), Extra large (1280px) (`extra-large`), Content container (`content-container`)	—	medium
Alignment	`alignment`	select	No	`center`	Start (`start`), Center (`center`), End (`end`)	For partial widths. Start and end follow the reading direction (right to left languages too).	start
Start decoration	`startDecoration`	select	No	`none`	None (`none`), Dot (`dot`), Square (`square`), Diamond (`diamond`)	—	square
Center decoration	`centerDecoration`	select	No	`none`	None (`none`), Dot (`dot`), Square (`square`), Diamond (`diamond`)	—	dot
End decoration	`endDecoration`	select	No	`none`	None (`none`), Dot (`dot`), Square (`square`), Diamond (`diamond`)	—	square
Background contrast	`contrastMode`	select	No	`standard`	Standard (`standard`), High (stronger line) (`high`)	High: a stronger colour, e.g. on busy or tinted backgrounds. Kept for separators authored before; see the other settings. Shown when `contrastMode` is `high`.	high
Show on desktop	`showDesktop`	boolean	No	`true`	on / off	—	false
Show on tablet	`showTablet`	boolean	No	`true`	on / off	—	false
Show on mobile	`showMobile`	boolean	No	`true`	on / off	—	false

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Desktop width	`desktopWidth`	select	No	inherit	As Appearance (`inherit`), 25% (`25-percent`), 50% (`50-percent`), 75% (`75-percent`), 100% (`100-percent`), Content width (`content-width`), Full bleed (section edge to edge) (`full-bleed`)	1200px and wider	50-percent
Desktop thickness	`desktopThickness`	select	No	inherit	As Appearance (`inherit`), Thin (1px) (`thin`), Medium (2px) (`medium`), Thick (3px) (`thick`)	—	medium
Desktop alignment	`desktopAlignment`	select	No	inherit	As Appearance (`inherit`), Start (`start`), Center (`center`), End (`end`)	—	start
Tablet width	`tabletWidth`	select	No	inherit	As Appearance (`inherit`), 25% (`25-percent`), 50% (`50-percent`), 75% (`75-percent`), 100% (`100-percent`), Content width (`content-width`), Full bleed (section edge to edge) (`full-bleed`)	600 to 1199px	50-percent
Tablet thickness	`tabletThickness`	select	No	inherit	As Appearance (`inherit`), Thin (1px) (`thin`), Medium (2px) (`medium`), Thick (3px) (`thick`)	—	thick
Tablet alignment	`tabletAlignment`	select	No	inherit	As Appearance (`inherit`), Start (`start`), Center (`center`), End (`end`)	—	center
Mobile width	`mobileWidth`	select	No	inherit	As Appearance (`inherit`), 25% (`25-percent`), 50% (`50-percent`), 75% (`75-percent`), 100% (`100-percent`), Content width (`content-width`), Full bleed (section edge to edge) (`full-bleed`)	up to 599px	100-percent
Mobile thickness	`mobileThickness`	select	No	inherit	As Appearance (`inherit`), Thin (1px) (`thin`), Medium (2px) (`medium`), Thick (3px) (`thick`)	—	thin
Mobile alignment	`mobileAlignment`	select	No	inherit	As Appearance (`inherit`), Start (`start`), Center (`center`), End (`end`)	—	center
Desktop top spacing	`desktopTopSpacing`	select	No	default	Default (`default`), None (`none`), 2XS (4px) (`2xs`), XS (8px) (`xs`), Small (16px) (`small`), Medium (24px) (`medium`), Large (40px) (`large`), XL (64px) (`xl`), 2XL (80px) (`2xl`)	—	xl
Desktop bottom spacing	`desktopBottomSpacing`	select	No	default	Default (`default`), None (`none`), 2XS (4px) (`2xs`), XS (8px) (`xs`), Small (16px) (`small`), Medium (24px) (`medium`), Large (40px) (`large`), XL (64px) (`xl`), 2XL (80px) (`2xl`)	—	none
Tablet top spacing	`tabletTopSpacing`	select	No	default	Default (`default`), None (`none`), 2XS (4px) (`2xs`), XS (8px) (`xs`), Small (16px) (`small`), Medium (24px) (`medium`), Large (40px) (`large`), XL (64px) (`xl`), 2XL (80px) (`2xl`)	—	small
Tablet bottom spacing	`tabletBottomSpacing`	select	No	default	Default (`default`), None (`none`), 2XS (4px) (`2xs`), XS (8px) (`xs`), Small (16px) (`small`), Medium (24px) (`medium`), Large (40px) (`large`), XL (64px) (`xl`), 2XL (80px) (`2xl`)	—	small

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Mobile top spacing	`mobileTopSpacing`	select	No	`default`	Default (`default`), None (`none`), 2XS (4px) (`2xs`), XS (8px) (`xs`), Small (16px) (`small`), Medium (24px) (`medium`), Large (40px) (`large`), XL (64px) (`xl`), 2XL (80px) (`2xl`)	—	none
Mobile bottom spacing	`mobileBottomSpacing`	select	No	`default`	Default (`default`), None (`none`), 2XS (4px) (`2xs`), XS (8px) (`xs`), Small (16px) (`small`), Medium (24px) (`medium`), Large (40px) (`large`), XL (64px) (`xl`), 2XL (80px) (`2xl`)	—	xs
Use section padding	`useSectionPadding`	boolean	No	`false`	on / off	On: no spacing of its own (the section's spacing only), so there's no double spacing.	true
Stretch to container width	`stretchToContainer`	boolean	No	`false`	on / off	The line fills its container on every breakpoint. Kept for separators authored before; see the other settings. Shown when `stretchToContainer` is `true`.	true
Respect content maximum width	`respectMaxWidth`	boolean	No	`true`	on / off	Never wider than the site's content width (also full bleed).	false
Animate on view	`animateOnView`	select	No	`none`	None (`none`), Fade (`fade`), Draw from start (`draw-from-start`), Draw from center (`draw-from-center`)	Once, when the separator scrolls into view.	fade
Reduced motion fallback	`reducedMotionFallback`	select	No	`static`	Show immediately (`static`), Short fade (`fade`)	For visitors who prefer reduced motion. Shown when `animateOnView` is not `none`.	static
Print	`printVisibility`	select	No	`show`	Show when printed (`show`), Hide when printed (`hide`)	—	hide
Analytics	`analyticsEnabled`	boolean	No	`false`	on / off	Adds the separator to the Adobe Data Layer (no interaction events).	true
Analytics label	`analyticsLabel`	text	No	—	—	Shown when `analyticsEnabled` is `true`.	Chapter break

Additional tab — Separator

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Anchor ID	`classes_anchor`	text	No	—	regExp: ^anchor-[a-z0-9][a-z0-9-]*$; customErrorMsg: Start with anchor-, then lower-case letters, digits and hyphens.	A unique ID of the block on the page, starting with anchor-, e.g. anchor-our-services; link to it with #anchor-our-services. Delivered as a block class.	—

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Hide block	classes_hideblock	boolean	No	false	on / off	Hides the whole block on the page until it is turned off (shown faded in the editor). Delivered as a block class.	—
Padding left	classes_paddingleft	select	No	""	Default (""), 0 (none) (pl-0), 0.25rem (space-100) (pl-100), 0.5rem (space-200) (pl-200), 0.75rem (space-300) (pl-300), 1rem (space-400) (pl-400), 1.25rem (space-500) (pl-500), 1.5rem (space-600) (pl-600), 2rem (space-800) (pl-800), 2.5rem (space-1000) (pl-1000), 3rem (space-1200) (pl-1200), 4rem (space-1600) (pl-1600), 5rem (space-2000) (pl-2000), 6rem (space-2400) (pl-2400), 7.5rem (space-3000) (pl-3000)	Delivered as a block class.	—
Padding right	classes_paddingright	select	No	""	Default (""), 0 (none) (pr-0), 0.25rem (space-100) (pr-100), 0.5rem (space-200) (pr-200), 0.75rem (space-300) (pr-300), 1rem (space-400) (pr-400), 1.25rem (space-500) (pr-500), 1.5rem (space-600) (pr-600), 2rem (space-800) (pr-800), 2.5rem (space-1000) (pr-1000), 3rem (space-1200) (pr-1200), 4rem (space-1600) (pr-1600), 5rem (space-2000) (pr-2000), 6rem (space-2400) (pr-2400), 7.5rem (space-3000) (pr-3000)	Delivered as a block class.	—
Padding top	classes_paddingtop	select	No	""	Default (""), 0 (none) (pt-0), 0.25rem (space-100) (pt-100), 0.5rem (space-200) (pt-200), 0.75rem (space-300) (pt-300), 1rem (space-400) (pt-400), 1.25rem (space-500) (pt-500), 1.5rem (space-600) (pt-600), 2rem (space-800) (pt-800), 2.5rem (space-1000) (pt-1000), 3rem (space-1200) (pt-1200), 4rem (space-1600) (pt-1600), 5rem (space-2000) (pt-2000), 6rem (space-2400) (pt-2400), 7.5rem (space-3000) (pt-3000)	Delivered as a block class.	—
Padding bottom	classes_paddingbottom	select	No	""	Default (""), 0 (none) (pb-0), 0.25rem (space-100) (pb-100), 0.5rem (space-200) (pb-200), 0.75rem (space-300) (pb-300), 1rem (space-400) (pb-400), 1.25rem (space-500) (pb-500), 1.5rem (space-600) (pb-600), 2rem (space-800) (pb-800), 2.5rem (space-1000) (pb-1000), 3rem (space-1200) (pb-1200), 4rem (space-1600) (pb-1600), 5rem (space-2000) (pb-2000), 6rem (space-2400) (pb-2400), 7.5rem (space-3000) (pb-3000)	Delivered as a block class.	—
Margin left	classes_marginleft	select	No	""	Default (""), 0 (none) (ml-0), 0.25rem (space-100) (ml-100), 0.5rem (space-200) (ml-200), 0.75rem (space-300) (ml-300), 1rem (space-400) (ml-400), 1.25rem (space-500) (ml-500), 1.5rem (space-600) (ml-600), 2rem (space-800) (ml-800), 2.5rem (space-1000) (ml-1000), 3rem (space-1200) (ml-1200), 4rem (space-1600) (ml-1600), 5rem (space-2000) (ml-2000), 6rem (space-2400) (ml-2400), 7.5rem (space-3000) (ml-3000)	Delivered as a block class.	—
Margin right	classes_marginright	select	No	""	Default (""), 0 (none) (mr-0), 0.25rem (space-100) (mr-100), 0.5rem (space-200) (mr-200), 0.75rem (space-300) (mr-300), 1rem (space-400) (mr-400), 1.25rem (space-500) (mr-500), 1.5rem (space-600) (mr-600), 2rem (space-800) (mr-800), 2.5rem (space-1000) (mr-1000), 3rem (space-1200) (mr-1200), 4rem (space-1600) (mr-1600), 5rem (space-2000) (mr-2000), 6rem (space-2400) (mr-2400), 7.5rem (space-3000) (mr-3000)	Delivered as a block class.	—
Margin top	classes_margintop	select	No	""	Default (""), 0 (none) (mt-0), 0.25rem (space-100) (mt-100), 0.5rem (space-200) (mt-200), 0.75rem (space-300) (mt-300), 1rem (space-400) (mt-400), 1.25rem (space-500) (mt-500), 1.5rem (space-600) (mt-600), 2rem (space-800) (mt-800), 2.5rem (space-1000) (mt-1000), 3rem (space-1200) (mt-1200), 4rem (space-1600) (mt-1600), 5rem (space-2000) (mt-2000), 6rem (space-2400) (mt-2400), 7.5rem (space-3000) (mt-3000)	Delivered as a block class.	—

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Margin bottom	classes_marginbottom	select	No	""	Default (""), 0 (none) (mb-0), 0.25rem (space-100) (mb-100), 0.5rem (space-200) (mb-200), 0.75rem (space-300) (mb-300), 1rem (space-400) (mb-400), 1.25rem (space-500) (mb-500), 1.5rem (space-600) (mb-600), 2rem (space-800) (mb-800), 2.5rem (space-1000) (mb-1000), 3rem (space-1200) (mb-1200), 4rem (space-1600) (mb-1600), 5rem (space-2000) (mb-2000), 6rem (space-2400) (mb-2400), 7.5rem (space-3000) (mb-3000)	Delivered as a block class.	—

Notes on the significant fields (the tables above give every label, default and allowed value). Each value is normalized by `separator-config.js` from a controlled list into a block class; the CSS maps the classes to custom properties and site tokens:

Field	Block class	Rendering, accessibility and data layer
Component ID	block `id`	Sanitized (lower case; letters, digits, `-`, `_`; a leading non-letter gets `separator-`); a duplicate on the page gets a numeric suffix; it replaces the Anchor ID; empty: the Anchor ID, else `separator-1`, `separator-2`, ... in page order
Accessibility mode	`semantic` / `decorative`	Semantic: an exposed <hr> (always rendered, even with Line style None); Decorative: the line is `aria-hidden="true"`
Accessible label	—	`aria-label` on the <hr>, Semantic only, at most 120 characters
Separator variant	`variant-*`	A preset of line style, thickness, colour and width (`VARIANT_PRESETS`); Inset also indents the line by `--space-1000` on both sides
Theme	`theme-*`	Light, Dark or Brand palette; Auto uses the light palette, and the dark / brand palette inside `.section.dark` / `.section.brand`
Line style	`line-*`	Solid, dashed, dotted, gradient (fades out at both ends); None: no line (Decorative: no <hr> at all)
Line thickness	`thickness-*`	`--border-width-100` / `200` / `300`
Line colour	`color-*`	The theme palette's token (`--color-border-*`, `--slate-*`, `--brand-*`, `--white-*`)
Line opacity	`opacity-*`	0.25 / 0.5 / 0.75 / 1
Separator width	`width-*`	A share of the container; Content width caps at `--content-max-width`; Full bleed extends over the section's `--section-padding-inline`
Maximum width	`max-*`	20rem, 40rem, 60rem, 80rem or `--content-max-width`
Alignment	`align-*`	Flex `justify-content` start / center / end (logical: follows the reading direction)
Decorations	`decorated`	`span.separator-decoration` elements, `aria-hidden`, sized from the thickness; none without a visible line
Background contrast	`contrast-high`	The strong colour of the palette instead of the Line colour
Show on ...	`hide-{bp}`, `hidden-all`	`display: none` in that breakpoint (no spacing kept); hidden everywhere: a dashed placeholder in the editor
Per-breakpoint width / thickness / alignment	`{bp}-width-*`, `{bp}-thickness-*`, `{bp}-align-*`	Applied only within the breakpoint's range; widths other than Full bleed reset the bleed
Top / bottom spacing	`{bp}-top-*`, `{bp}-bottom-*`	Padding (never collapses): None 0, 2XS `--space-100`, XS `--space-200`, Small `--space-400`, Medium `--space-600`, Large `--space-1000`, XL `--space-1600`, 2XL `--space-2000`; Default `--space-600`
Use section padding	`section-padding`	No own vertical spacing on any breakpoint

Field	Block class	Rendering, accessibility and data layer
Stretch to container width	`stretch`	The line fills its container whatever the width settings (maximum widths still apply)
Respect content maximum width	`respect-max`	Caps the line at `--content-max-width`, full bleed included
Animate on view	`animate-*`, `motion-*`	Once, when 10 % is in view (IntersectionObserver)
Print	`print-hide`	Hidden when printed; otherwise printed at full opacity
Analytics / Analytics label	`data-analytics`	On: one data-layer state entry with the label as `dc:title` (at most 120 characters); off: the separator isn't tracked

Legacy mapping. Values authored before are still read: Separator width "Auto" (`auto`, rendered as 100 %) and variant "Custom" (`custom-design`, rendered as Default) were removed from the dialog (block ecosystem audit, handover 2.27); Component ID, Background contrast and Stretch to container width are shown in the dialog only when a separator already has a value ("Kept for separators authored before"). Widths written as "50%" or "50 percent" are read as `50-percent`; booleans accept true / yes / on / 1 / y and false / no / off / 0 / n; unknown values fall back to the defaults.

Additional tab. Anchor ID, Hide block and Padding / Margin: see AGENTS.md "Additional tab". The Separator has no Animation Type, Motion Speed or Animation Trigger (it animates with Animate on view; `test/motion/motion.test.mjs` checks it is left out). The Additional tab's Padding top / bottom classes can override the separator's own spacing (handover 6.26.13, Issue 5).

4. Screenshot-Based Authoring Steps

Authoring Step 1: Add a semantic separator

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
separator-authoring-step-1.png

Purpose:
The General tab of a new Separator with Semantic mode and an Accessible label.

Annotations:
A = Accessibility mode
B = Accessible label
C = Separator variant
D = Theme
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
A	Accessibility mode	Semantic (a thematic break)	The topic changes	<hr> exposed to screen readers
B	Accessible label	End of the story	Names the break	`aria-label="End of the story"`
C	Separator variant	Default	Standard rule	Solid thin line, 100 %
D	Theme	Auto (as the section)	Plain section	Light palette

Author action: Add (+) › Separator between two stories; open General. Expected preview: a thin grey line with 1.5rem above and below. Expected published result: the same. Business rule: the label is used only in Semantic mode. Validation: the accessibility tree shows a separator named "End of the story". Common mistake: Semantic for a purely visual rule; resolution: Decorative.

Authoring Step 2: A branded accent

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
separator-authoring-step-2.png

Purpose:
The Style tab of a Branded separator at 25 % width, aligned to the start.

Annotations:
A = Separator variant (General tab)
B = Separator width
C = Alignment
D = Desktop top spacing
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
A	Separator variant	Branded	Brand accent	Solid medium brand line
B	Separator width	25%	Short accent	A quarter of the content width
C	Alignment	Start	Under the start of the title	Line at the start edge
D	Desktop top spacing	None	Directly under the title	No gap above on desktop

Author action: set the values. Expected preview: a short brand line directly under the title on desktop. Business rule: Start follows the reading direction. Validation: check at 1440px and 390px. Common mistake: changing Line colour away from "As the variant" and losing the brand colour; resolution: reset to "As the variant".

Authoring Step 3: Per-device settings

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
separator-authoring-step-3.png

Purpose:
The per-device fields of the Style tab: Show on tablet and mobile off.

Annotations:
A = Show on desktop
B = Show on tablet
C = Show on mobile
D = Desktop width
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
A	Show on desktop	On	Divider between desktop columns	Visible from 1200px
B	Show on tablet	Off	Columns stack	Hidden 600–1199px, no spacing
C	Show on mobile	Off	Columns stack	Hidden under 600px, no spacing
D	Desktop width	As Appearance	Keep the Appearance width	Unchanged on desktop

Author action: set the toggles. Expected preview: the line only at desktop widths. Business rule: hidden on every device shows nothing on the page and a dashed note in the editor. Validation: resize the preview

across 600px and 1200px. Common mistake: turning all three off; resolution: delete the separator instead.

Authoring Step 4: Preview, publish and verify

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
separator-authoring-step-4.png

Purpose:
The published separators at desktop and mobile widths compared with the preview.

Annotations:
A = Semantic separator
B = Branded accent
C = Desktop-only divider (absent on mobile)
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
A	Preview	On, at 1440px and 390px	Per-device settings	The intended lines per width
B	Publish	The page	Live page	The same on aem.live

Author action: preview at several widths, publish. Validation: one line per intended separator and device. Common mistake: double spacing with the section spacing; resolution: Use section padding or smaller spacing.

5. Variations

The variations are the values of `_separator.json`, normalized by `separator-config.js` (`VARIANTS`, `THEMES`, `LINE_STYLES`, `WIDTHS`, `ANIMATIONS`, …) and styled in `separator.css`.

Semantic, Decorative, Spacing only

What it is	Settings	Screen readers	Markup
Thematic break (the topic changes)	Accessibility mode **Semantic**	Announce a separator (with the Accessible label as its name, if set)	`hr.separator-rule` (`aria-label` when labelled)
Visual division only	**Decorative** (default)	Ignore it	`div.separator-line[aria-hidden="true"] > hr`
Spacing only	Decorative + Line style **None**	Nothing	No <hr>; the block keeps its spacing

A Semantic separator with Line style None is still a break for screen readers but nothing is visible; the editor warns about it (placeholder `separatorInvisible`).

Variants: Default, Subtle, Strong, Inset, Full width, Dotted, Dashed, Gradient, Branded

Presets (`VARIANT_PRESETS`): Default solid thin default 100 %; Subtle solid thin subtle 100 %; Strong solid medium strong 100 %; Inset solid thin default 100 % with a `--space-1000` inset; Full width solid thin default full bleed; Dotted dotted medium default; Dashed dashed thin default; Gradient gradient medium primary; Branded solid medium primary 100 %. Any Style setting other than "As the variant" overrides the preset.

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
```

```
separator-variants-mobile.png

Purpose:
All nine variants stacked at 390px, each labelled.

Annotations:
A = Default
B = Inset (indented)
C = Full width (over the section padding)
D = Gradient
```

Themes: Auto, Light, Dark, Brand

Auto follows the section: the dark palette inside `.section.dark`, the brand palette inside `.section.brand`, else the light palette. Choose Light, Dark or Brand when the background isn't such a section (an image, or Section Style Dark / Dark Green, whose theme contract changes only `--color-border-brand`, i.e. the Primary colour).

Widths, maximum width, alignment, stretch

25 / 50 / 75 / 100 %, Content width, Full bleed; Maximum width Small to Extra large or Content container; Alignment Start / Center / End (logical, right-to-left aware); Stretch to container width (legacy) fills the container; Respect content maximum width caps every width at `--content-max-width`. Full bleed uses the section's inline padding, so it never overflows the page.

Decorations: dot, square, diamond

At the start, centre and / or end of the line; visual only (`aria-hidden`), coloured as the line, sized with the thickness.

Responsive visibility and overrides

Show on desktop / tablet / mobile; per-breakpoint width, thickness, alignment and spacing ("As Appearance" / Default keep the general values).

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
separator-responsive-overrides-tablet.png

Purpose:
A separator with Desktop width 50 %, Tablet width 75 % and Mobile width 100 % at 1024px: the tablet
value applies.

Annotations:
A = Line at 75 % on tablet
```

Animate on view: Fade, Draw from start, Draw from center

Once, when 10 % of the block is in view: the line fades in (0.6s opacity) or scales from its start (right in right-to-left) or centre. For reduced motion: Show immediately (no animation is prepared) or Short fade (opacity only). The hidden starting state exists only after the script added `animate-ready`, so a failure never hides the line.

Print and Analytics

Hide when printed removes it from print; Analytics on adds its state to the data layer (see Data Layer and Analytics).

6. Complete Authoring Example

Scenario: a chapter break between two case studies on a long article page.

Field	Example value	Guidance
Accessibility mode	Semantic (a thematic break)	The topic changes
Accessible label	End of the story	Short, translated per locale
Separator variant	Default	Standard rule
Theme	Auto (as the section)	Plain section
Line thickness	Medium (2px)	A stronger break
Separator width	50%	Centred half-width rule
Center decoration	Diamond	Chapter mark
Desktop top / bottom spacing	Large (40px) / Large (40px)	Room around the break
Show on desktop / tablet / mobile	On / On / On	Everywhere
Animate on view	None	Static
Analytics / Analytics label	On / Chapter break	State in the data layer

Steps: add the separator between the two stories (Authoring Step 1), set the Style values (Step 2), keep it visible everywhere (Step 3), preview and publish (Step 4).

Expected output: a 2px grey line at half the content width, centred, with a diamond in its middle and 2.5rem above and below on desktop (1.5rem default on tablet and mobile).

Responsive: the desktop spacing applies from 1200px; tablet and mobile use the default spacing.

Accessibility: a named separator in the accessibility tree; the diamond is hidden from assistive technology.

Analytics / data layer: one state entry `tcs-corp/components/separator` with `dc:title` "Chapter break"; no events.

Personalization fallback: none; the authored separator renders.

Pre-publish checklist:

- [ ] Semantic only for real topic changes; never Semantic with Line style None.
- [ ] Visible on the intended devices (not hidden everywhere).
- [ ] No double spacing with the section spacing.
- [ ] Line visible on its background (Theme / Background contrast).
- [ ] Accessible label translated per locale.

7. Content and Asset Guidelines

- **Titles, descriptions, eyebrows, CTAs, links, images, icons.** Not applicable: the separator renders no text, links or images on the published page.
- **Labels.** Accessible label and Analytics label are cut to 120 characters (handover recommendation: about 60 and 40); keep the Analytics label and Component ID identical across locales, translate the Accessible label.
- **Tags and metadata.** None.
- **Min / max items.** No verified technical limit was identified.
- **Asset source / loading / fallback.** None (no assets).

8. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Diagnostic steps	Resolution	Verification
Separator not visible	All Show on ... off; Hide block on; Decorative with Line style None; low opacity / subtle colour	Edit mode note; Additional tab; ? `debug=separator` on preview	Turn on the devices, turn off Hide block, choose a visible style	Line in Preview at all intended widths
Editor note "Semantic separator without a line"	Semantic with Line style None	General and Style tabs	Decorative (spacing only) or a visible style	Note gone
Theme Auto stays light on a dark background	Auto follows only `.section.dark` / `.section.brand` (not background images or Section Style Dark / Dark Green)	Inspect the section's classes	Set Theme Dark or Brand; consider High contrast	Line visible
Double spacing	1.5rem default spacing plus section spacing	Inspect the block's padding	Use section padding or smaller spacing	Gaps as designed
Spacing settings have no effect	Use section padding on; Additional Padding top / bottom override; wrong preview width	Check the fields and the width	Turn them off; preview at the breakpoint	Gap changes
Anchor links don't jump	A Component ID replaces the Anchor ID, or was sanitized / suffixed	Inspect the block `id`; ? `debug=separator`	Link to the actual id or clear the Component ID	Link scrolls
Animation doesn't play	Reduced motion with Show immediately; already in view on load (plays at once); no IntersectionObserver	OS setting; classes `animate-ready` / `is-visible`	Expected behavior	Plays when scrolled into view

Evidence to collect (no secrets): URL, viewport, the block's classes and `id`, the `?debug=separator` console output, the section's classes.

9. Screenshots

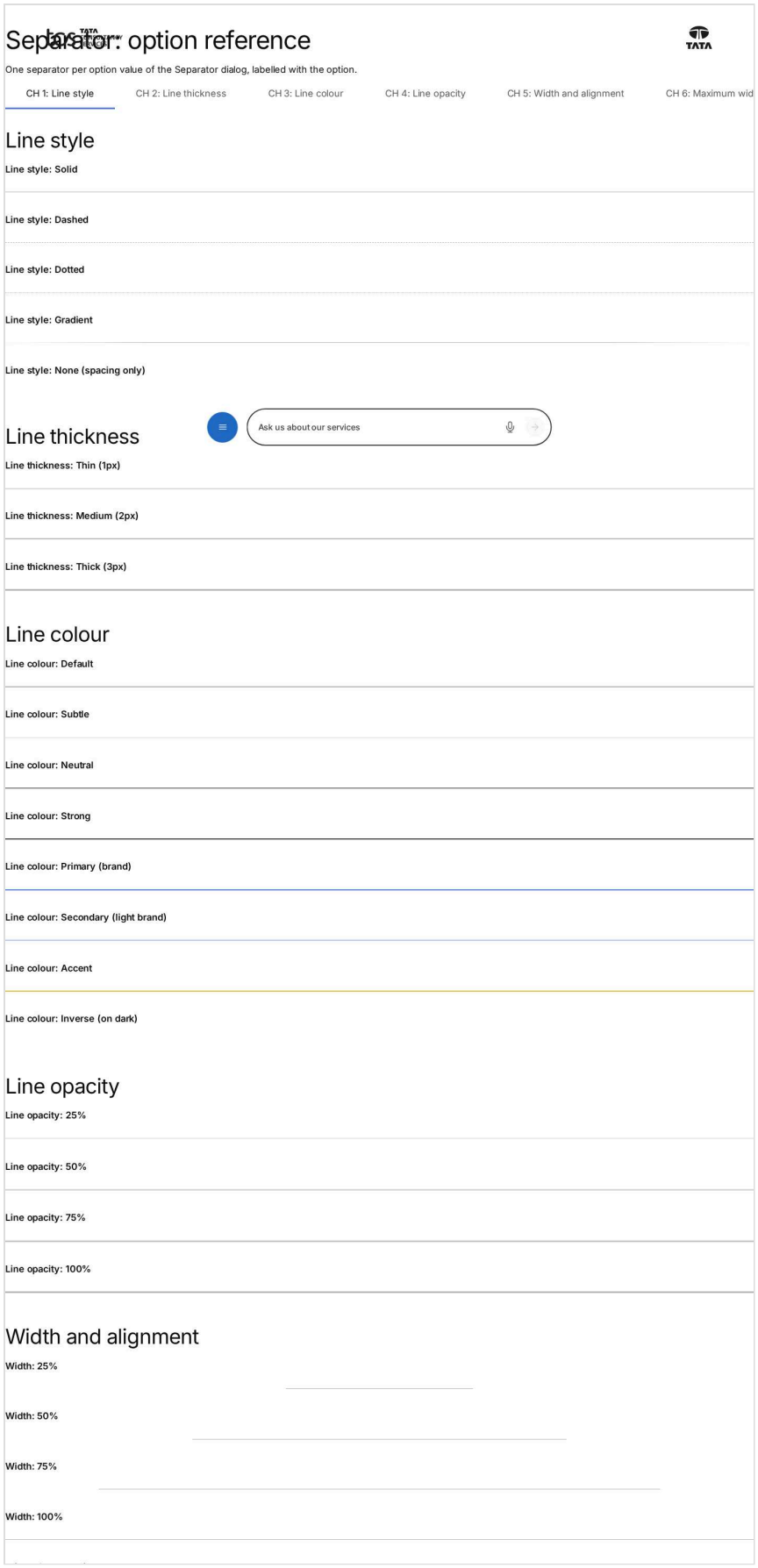


Figure: Separator as published (block library) — desktop 1440 × 900 (/design-block-master/en/block-library/separator/option-reference, captured 2026-11-08).

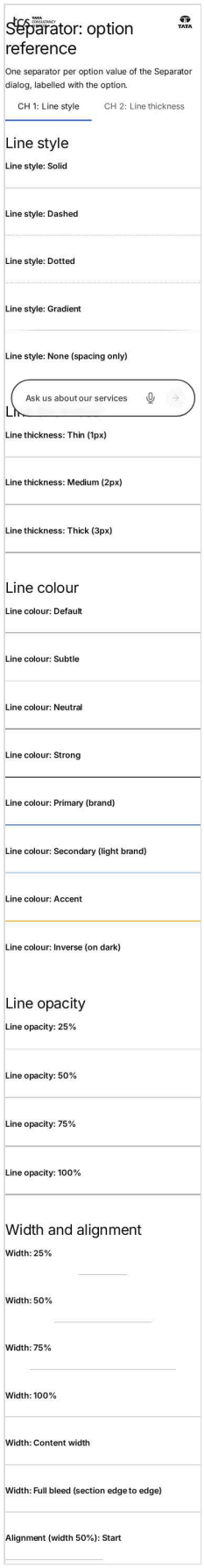


Figure: Separator as published (block library) — mobile 375 × 812 (/design-block-master/en/block-library/separator/option-reference, captured 2026-11-08).

> **Screenshot required**

> - Required screen: Separator dialog in Universal Editor (every tab, including Additional)
> - Required role/access: AEM Sites author with Universal Editor (content author)
> - Required navigation steps: AEM Sites console > /content/tcs-corp/language-masters/en > open a page in Universal Editor
> - Reason unavailable: No AEM author access in the documentation program (access blocker AB-01)
> - Owner: Content Lead / AEM Authoring Lead (proposed)
> - Target completion date: To be confirmed

10. Known limitations

- Universal Editor screenshots are placeholders: no author access in this program.

11. Open items

- None.

12. Change history

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	8 November 2026	Delivery team (documentation program)	First version of the role-specific documentation (master documentation prompt), generated from the repository and the published reference pages